

The Goose That Laid Golden Eggs

A farmer and his wife owned a goose that was unlike any other bird in the village. One morning, while gathering eggs, the farmer found a smooth, heavy egg gleaming in the straw. At first he thought someone had played a joke on him, but the gold was real. He sold the egg and brought home enough money to repair the roof and buy food for many weeks.

The next morning the goose laid another golden egg. Then another the day after that. The farmer and his wife became comfortable. They bought better clothes, filled their pantry, and spoke proudly of their good fortune. At first they treated the goose well, giving her clean water and fresh grain. But as they watched the small pile of coins grow, their minds turned from gratitude to impatience.

"Why must we wait one day at a time?" the farmer asked. "Surely the goose holds many golden eggs inside her." His wife was uneasy. "We have more than we once dreamed of," she said. "Let us be content." But the farmer imagined chests of gold and a life without waiting. Each morning's single egg began to feel smaller to him, even though nothing about it had changed.

At last greed overcame his judgment. Believing he could take all the golden eggs at once, he killed the goose. But inside he found only what any ordinary goose would have. There was no hidden treasure, no storehouse of gold, and no way to bring the bird back. The farmer stood in the quiet yard with empty hands.

For a long time, the couple had to live carefully again. The farmer often remembered the egg that had seemed too little only because he had started expecting too much. He learned that a steady gift can be more valuable than a sudden fortune, especially when it is cared for. The wife kept a simple clay bowl on the kitchen shelf as a reminder: enough is not a small thing. It is often the very thing that greed makes people fail to see.